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August 30, 1989

Mr. Dan O'Riordan
Community Relations Officer
U.S. EPA Office of Public Affairs
U.S. EPA Region V
231 S. Dearborn Street
Chicago, IL 60604

EPA Region 5 Records Ctr.



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Dear Mr. O'Riordan:

ASI Environmental Technologies has reviewed E.C. Jordan's Remedial Investigation/Feasibility Study (RI/FS) for Kysor of Cadillac, Inc. and Northern Plating Company, Cadillac, Michigan Recommended Cleanup Action. ASI is submitting these written comments on behalf of Four Winns, Inc. Focusing specifically on Four Winns, Inc.'s involvement in the RI/FS, we are providing a brief project history and also a perspective of the proposed soil and groundwater remediations.

Four Winns voluntarily negotiated with the Michigan Department of Natural Resources (MDNR) and subsequently contracted with ASI to conduct a hydrogeological investigation at their Frisbie Street facility in Cadillac, Michigan. The purpose of the study was to determine the hydrogeologic profiles and aquifer characteristics of the area and define the study area. Prior to initiating the study, a work plan for the investigation was prepared and voluntarily submitted by Four Winns. This work plan was designed to define the study area in compliance with MDNR and U.S. EPA requirements. MDNR staff reviewed and approved the work plan.

The ensuing investigation complied with all aspects of the approved work plan which focused on groundwater characteristics of the area. The information gathered during the investigation was to be used in conjunction with data from other studies to define the study area.

Data obtained from the approved Four Winns investigations and other investigations utilized in the RI/FS is insufficient to adequately characterize soils at the Four Winns site. We concur with E.C. Jordan's conclusion as set forth on page 19 of the 1989 FS. The lack of data makes the need for and choice of any soil remediation technology for the Four Winns site premature. A more thorough soils investigation should be initiated to determine the extent of soil contamination in the barrel storage area. Once the area has been fully characterized, appropriate treatment technologies can be explored. Four Winns is willing to meet immediately with MDNR and/or U.S. EPA officials to generate a work plan to address soil contamination at the site.

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The original work plan was designed to facilitate definition of the study area by monitoring groundwater quality at the Four Winns site. Through extensive monitoring well installations and water sampling, it was determined that Four Winns may have been partially responsible for VOC contamination in the shallow aquifer. While the treatment proposed in the RI/FS appears to be technically feasible, it is scaled to address the plumes of the major PRPs and is not practicably applicable to Four Winns.

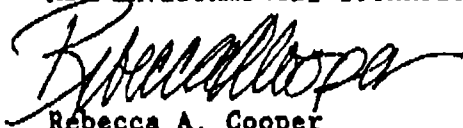
A groundwater treatment proposal was discussed with Four Winns in 1986. The treatment proposed by ASI was granular activated carbon (GAC). Treatment of the contaminated groundwater via granular activated carbon would result in meeting the discharge limits for the constituents outlined in the RI/FS. Discharge of the effluent would be to the sanitary sewer or Clam River, depending on permit specifications. At the time of the proposal, Four Winns endorsed the mode of treatment and would have implemented the plan, but realized that implementation prior to the RI/FS might have significantly influenced contaminant plumes from the major PRPs.

Four Winns is willing to consider remediation in the immediate area in accordance with the 1986 proposal. While Four Winns recognizes that they would be remediating a portion of the other PRPs' plumes, they are prepared to consider participation in a clean up concurrent with, but separately from other parties.

In conclusion, Four Winns is concerned with protecting the public health and environment which is evidenced by their consistent willingness to comply with the MDNR and U.S. EPA further requirements. This continuing cooperation is reflected in their readiness to further investigate the soils and institute an appropriate groundwater remediation program at the Four Winns site.

If you have any questions regarding this comment, please contact either Mr. David Skrocki or me at (616) 845-0371.

ASI Environmental Technologies



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DATE: Aug 31, 1989

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